SIMETICONE

Not absorbed
Infant colic

CHEMICAL NAME Mixture of polydimethylsiloxane (dimeticone) and silicon dioxide
CLASS Antifoaming agent (antiflatulent)
TRADE NAMES Infacol · Gas-X · Espumisan · Mylicon

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Flatulence, bloating, abdominal discomfort from gas.
- Infant colic (wind) — evidence limited.
- Before endoscopy/ultrasound to reduce gas bubbles.
- Often combined with antacids.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Lowers **surface tension of gas bubbles** → small bubbles coalesce and are passed more easily (belching or flatus).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** chewable tablets (chew well), capsules or drops after meals and at bedtime.
- Infant drops before each feed.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Very rare: mild GI upset, nausea.
- Constipation (rare).

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hypersensitivity (rare).

DOSAGES

- **Adult:** 40–125 mg after meals and at bedtime (max 500 mg/day).
- **Infants:** 20–40 mg (0.5–1 mL) before each feed (max 6 doses/day).
- **Before imaging:** 80–200 mg.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- Suspected bowel obstruction or perforation.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- May ↓ absorption of levothyroxine (separate doses).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** minutes.
- Not absorbed — excreted unchanged in faeces.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess abdominal distension and pain to exclude serious causes.
- Infant colic: support parents; check feeding technique.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Chew tablets thoroughly.
- Give drops before infant feeds.
- Seek help for vomiting, blood in stool, fever or a hard swollen tummy.

KEY POINTS

- Antifoaming agent; breaks gas bubbles.
- Infant colic and bloating.
- Not absorbed; very safe.
- Before imaging.